

Taking over a slipping programme — the first 10 moves

What I do, in this order, when I land on a slipping programme. Help yourself.

- 1.** Collect the latest version of every plan in circulation — how many there are is the first diagnosis.
- 2.** Rebuild one single dated plan, one owner per milestone: the source of truth for every stakeholder.
- 3.** List the pending decisions, and who can take them — programmes rarely slip for lack of work, usually for lack of arbitration.
- 4.** Objectify the gap — workload, schedule, budget — with sourced figures, not impressions.
- 5.** Map the risks: one named owner and one dated mitigation each. Beyond fifteen, nothing is a risk any more.
- 6.** Restore a committee that decides: the agenda is arbitration — not status review.
- 7.** Set the cadence: weekly, same time, same length, non-negotiable.
- 8.** Identify the three dependencies blocking everything else, and deal with them first.
- 9.** Ring-fence what has to land — and apply “In offsets Out” to everything that comes in.
- 10.** Announce the tenable date, early: bad news announced in time can still be steered.